

THISTLEBRIGHT ADVENTURES

A fairy-tale tabletop RPG for brave 5–7 year olds



STYLE PROOF: CLEAN RESTART

Scottish fairy myth, high fantasy, simple choices, warm artwork, and print-first page design.

PART 1

Making a Hero



WELCOME TO THE GLEN

Every adventure begins with a tiny brave choice. The Guide reads the scene, the players say what they try, and the dice help everyone discover what happens next.

THE TABLE RULE

Thistlebright is played by talking together. A grown-up Guide describes a place, then each child says what their hero tries. The rules stay small so the story can stay big.

When to roll

Roll	What happens
1–2	A wobble: something funny or inconvenient happens.
3–4	A yes, but: success with a tiny cost or choice.
5–6	A bright success: the hero does it well.

The three numbers

Read aloud: “You hear bells under the heather. A fox with silver whiskers bows and waits. What do you do?”

Only roll when the answer is exciting. If an idea is safe and simple, it works. If it is tricky, roll one six-sided die.

Kindness rule: heroes can be scared, surprised, muddy, or silly, but the story never punishes a child for trying to help.

- **Brave** for daring, protecting, and standing tall.
- **Kind** for helping, calming, and making friends.
- **Quick** for sneaking, catching, and balancing.



STEP 1: PICK YOUR KINDRED

Your kindred is your fairy-tale people. It gives one story gift and a way to picture your hero. Nobody is better or worse because of their kindred.

KINDREDS OF THISTLEBRIGHT

Glenfolk

Practical children from cottages, crofts, and market lanes.

- **Gift:** once per adventure, remember a useful local clue.
- **Look:** tartan scarf, muddy boots, treasure pockets.

Thistle Fairy

Small bright folk with shimmer, manners, and secret paths.

- **Gift:** once per scene, notice nearby fairy magic.
- **Look:** petal cloak, star freckles, tiny crown.

Brownie Helper

Cozy fixers who tidy, mend, and improve small things.

- **Gift:** repair or improve one tiny object each scene.
- **Look:** apron, tool pouch, flour on nose.

Selkie-Born

Gentle loch-hearted heroes with moonlit dreams.

- **Gift:** understand water, weather, or a sad feeling.
- **Look:** soft seal-cloak, shell button, sea-glass charm.



STEP 2: PICK YOUR ADVENTURE JOB

Your job is what you like doing when adventure starts. It gives one bigger class gift that helps the whole table.

ADVENTURE JOBS

Thistle Knight

Protects friends and stands bravely at the front.

Gift: once per scene, turn a scary moment into a brave one.

Loch Scout

Finds paths, listens for clues, and spots hidden doors.

Gift: ask the Guide one “what do I notice?” question.

Song-Spark Bard

Uses music, jokes, and stories to lift everyone up.

Gift: give another hero +1 after a kind song or cheer.

Hearth Mage

Carries warm, safe magic: sparks, steam, tea, and tiny lights.

Gift: create a small helpful magical effect.

Beast Friend

Understands animals and earns trust with gentle patience.

Gift: ask a friendly creature for a small favor.



BESTIARY STYLE

Creatures are encounters, friends, mysteries, or puzzles — not bags of hit points. Every entry keeps a picture, a feeling, and a table action together.

CREATURE ENTRY PATTERN



Art rule: image first, overlay second, never a floating framed box.

A young water horse with silver mane and shy eyes. It wants someone to find the bell it lost under the reeds.

Kind solution: sing softly, offer oats, or ask the loch what it remembers.

For this age group, a creature should usually have a feeling before it has a fight. Scared, lonely, proud, sleepy, hungry, confused, or protective gives children something to respond to.

Moon-Kelpie Foal

At the table	Use this
Wants	Its moon-bell returned.
Helps by	Carrying one hero safely across shallow water.
Complication	It splashes when nervous and soaks the map.

Guide note

CHARACTER SHEET STYLE

This sheet is deliberately large, printable, and chunky. A five-year-old should be able to point at each box and explain it.

Hero name	Player name
Kindred	Adventure job
Brave □ □ □	Kind □ □ □
Quick □ □ □	Treasure
Draw your hero	My helper question When I am stuck, I can ask...